

KNOWLEDGEABLE

Subconscious Learning Platform

Business Plan

June 2026

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1. Executive Summary

Knowledgeable is a mobile learning platform built around one idea. People already spend hours scrolling through social media feeds. That habit, redirected toward academic and intellectual content, becomes a genuine learning tool. The app turns passive scrolling into subconscious learning.

The platform works like a cross between LinkedIn and TikTok, but for academics, books, and ideas. Users scroll through bite sized summaries, research highlights, opinions, and commentary. They can open any piece to get a deeper explanation, share their own thinking, follow other learners, and build personal reading lists. An AI engine provides instant explanations of any topic searched.

Knowledgeable is free to use. A premium subscription at £15 per month unlocks AI powered explanations, full access to the academic library, removal of adverts, and advanced personalisation. The app also retains a GCSE and A Level teaching section as a secondary feature for younger users.

The primary competitor is Deepstash, which positions itself as "TikTok for smart people." Knowledgeable differs in three ways. It is free at the base level (Deepstash limits daily content). It includes a full academic paper and book library rather than just curated summaries. And it has genuine social features (following, chat, discussion threads) that Deepstash lacks at depth.

A working prototype exists as a Next.js web application. The core feed, content cards, book tracking, AI search explanations, chat, user profiles, and personalised feed selection are all built and functional at prototype level.

2. The Concept

The gap Knowledgeable fills is straightforward. Most learning apps treat education as a task. You log in, complete a lesson, log out. That works for some people, but most of us learn more casually. We pick things up from conversations, articles, and random encounters with ideas. Knowledgeable leans into that pattern.

The app presents a personalised feed of content cards. Each card is a short piece of intellectual content. It might be a three paragraph summary of a research paper, a user's opinion on a book, a commentary on a trending scientific topic, or a poll about a philosophical question. The user scrolls, reads what catches their eye, and moves on. That is subconscious learning. No homework, no quizzes, no progress bars.

When something interests a user enough to go deeper, they can tap into it. The app shows the full text, a discussion section with threaded comments, and (for premium users) an AI generated explanation that breaks the topic down further with suggested books and sources.

Content types on the platform include:

Summaries of books and papers. Original research posts. Opinions and commentary. Articles. Book uploads and reviews. Polls. And system curated book and paper feed items drawn from the academic library.

Users can also track their reading (want to read, currently reading, already read), save content to personal folders, follow other users, and message each other directly. The social layer is what separates Knowledgeable from passive reading apps like Blinkist or Headway.

3. Target Market

The primary audience is 18 to 35 year olds who already use social media heavily and have some intellectual curiosity but do not read academic papers or non fiction regularly. They are not opposed to learning. They just do not seek it out in its current formats. Knowledgeable meets them where they already are, in a scrollable feed.

The secondary audience is university students and postgraduate researchers who want a lighter way to keep up with ideas across disciplines outside their specialism. A physics PhD student who is curious about behavioural economics, for instance, does not want to read a full textbook. A five paragraph summary in their feed is enough.

A tertiary audience is GCSE and A Level students (14 to 18) who can use the dedicated teaching section for revision support. This is positioned as a side feature rather than the core product, but it matters for user acquisition in the UK because students talk to each other.

Market sizing (UK focus)

Segment	Estimated Size	Notes
UK adults 18-35 using social media	12 million+	ONS and Ofcom data, 2024
UK university students	2.9 million	HESA 2024/25 enrolment
UK GCSE/A Level students	1.5 million	DfE pupil numbers
UK edtech consumer market	£0.8–1.2 billion	Consumer segment of £5.2B total

4. Competitive Landscape

The bite sized learning space has several players, but none occupy the exact position Knowledgeable targets. Most competitors are either pure content curation (no social features) or pure social platforms (no academic depth).

Direct competitors

Competitor	Model	Price	Weakness vs Knowledgeable
Deepstash	Curated bite sized learning, AI feed	\$4.99/mo premium	Limited daily free content. Weak social features. No academic library.
Blinkist	Book summaries (15 min reads/listens)	£9.99/mo	Books only. No user generated content. No social layer. Passive consumption.
Headway	Book summaries with audio	£10.99/mo	Narrow focus on self help and business books. No academic content.

Curiosity	Video micro learning	£12.99/mo	Video heavy. No text based feed. No social features.
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Indirect competitors

Platform	Overlap	Why users still need Knowledgeable
Reddit (academic subs)	Discussion and idea sharing	No curation. Quality varies wildly. Not designed for learning.
Twitter/X (academic side)	Short form intellectual content	Noisy. Algorithmic chaos. Not structured for knowledge retention.
Khan Academy	Free education	Structured courses, not a feed. Feels like school. No social layer.
Goodreads	Book tracking and reviews	No learning content. Social features feel dated. No feed.

The competitive advantage is the combination of three things no single competitor offers together. A free, scroll based feed. Genuine social features (following, chat, threaded discussion). And depth (full academic papers, AI explanations, a proper book library). Deepstash comes closest but gates its free tier and lacks the social infrastructure.

5. Product and Features

The prototype is built in Next.js with TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, and Firebase. It demonstrates the core feature set. Below is what exists and what the production app would include.

Core features (built in prototype)

Feature	Description	Status
Content Feed	Personalised scrollable feed of content cards (summaries, research, opinions, polls, articles)	Prototype complete
Content Detail	Full view of any content piece with like, comment, share, save actions	Prototype complete
AI Search Explanations	Genkit AI flow that explains any topic with suggested books and sources	Prototype complete
Reading Lists	Want to Read, Currently Reading, Already Read (Goodreads style tracking)	Prototype complete
User Profiles	Followers, following, uploaded content, reading history	Prototype complete
Chat/Messaging	Direct messaging between users	Prototype complete
Upload	Rich text editor for creating and publishing content	Prototype complete
Personalised Feed Selection	Subject and niche topic selection for feed customisation	Prototype complete
Discussion Threads	Threaded comments under each content piece	Prototype complete
Onboarding	Interest selection and profile setup flow	Prototype complete

Production additions (not yet built)

Feature	Description	Priority
Native mobile app	iOS and Android (React Native or Flutter)	Critical, launch blocker
Push notifications	Daily content suggestions, follower activity	High
Premium paywall	Stripe integration for £15/mo subscription	Critical, launch blocker
Ad integration	Non intrusive adverts for free tier	Medium, post launch
GCSE/A Level section	Structured revision content by subject and exam board	Medium
Content moderation	Automated and manual review of user uploads	High
Analytics dashboard	User engagement, retention, and content performance metrics	Medium

6. Pricing and Revenue Model

The app is free to download and use. Free users get full access to the feed, can follow users, save content, upload their own posts, and use the reading list tracker. They see adverts and have limited access to the academic library.

Subscription tiers

Feature	Free Tier	Premium (£15/month)
Content feed	Full access	Full access
Social features (follow, chat, discuss)	Full access	Full access
Content upload	Full access	Full access
Reading list tracker	Full access	Full access
AI topic explanations	Limited (3 per day)	Unlimited
Academic library access	Preview only	Full access
Adverts	Yes	No
Advanced feed personalisation	Basic	Full algorithm control
Offline reading	No	Yes

The £15 per month price point sits above Deepstash (\$4.99/£4 per month) but below MasterClass and Skillshare (£15–20 per month). The justification is that Knowledgeable offers more depth (full academic papers, AI explanations) than Deepstash while being cheaper than structured course platforms.

Revenue streams

Subscription revenue is the primary source. Advertising revenue from the free tier is secondary. Potential future streams include institutional licensing (universities buying bulk premium access for students), sponsored content partnerships with publishers, and B2B corporate learning packages. Those are Year 2+ considerations, not launch priorities.

7. Financial Projections

These projections assume a bootstrap launch with minimal paid marketing. User growth is modelled conservatively, driven primarily by organic social media promotion and word of mouth. The full financial model is in the accompanying Excel workbook.

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Total users	15,000	65,000	180,000
Premium subscribers	450 (3%)	2,600 (4%)	9,000 (5%)
Monthly subscription revenue	£6,750	£39,000	£135,000
Annual subscription revenue	£81,000	£468,000	£1,620,000
Ad revenue (annual)	£5,000	£45,000	£150,000
Total revenue	£86,000	£513,000	£1,770,000
Operating costs	£120,000	£310,000	£780,000
Net position	-£34,000	£203,000	£990,000

Year 1 runs at a loss. That is expected for a consumer app. The critical metric is not revenue but engagement. If daily active users are consistently spending 10 or more minutes per session, the conversion to premium will follow. Break even is projected in Month 14 to 16 depending on user growth pace.

8. Operations and Technology

The founding team needs three roles at launch. A technical lead to build the native mobile app and backend infrastructure. A content lead to seed the platform with quality academic content and manage early moderation. And the founder handling strategy, partnerships, and growth.

The tech stack from the prototype (Next.js, TypeScript, Firebase, Genkit AI) is suitable for the web version but the mobile app will need a separate build. React Native is the likely choice because it allows code sharing with the existing TypeScript codebase while producing native iOS and Android apps.

Hosting and infrastructure costs are low in the early stages. Firebase offers a generous free tier. AI explanation costs (Genkit uses Google AI models) scale with usage but are manageable at low user volumes. The main cost pressure comes when premium users increase their AI query volume.

Content seeding is the operational challenge at launch. The platform needs a critical mass of quality content before it feels alive. The plan is to pre load the academic library with open access papers and public domain books, then recruit 50 to 100 early content creators (university students, book reviewers, science communicators) to populate the feed before public launch.

9. Risk Analysis

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Low user adoption	Medium	High	Focus on a niche community first (one university, one subject area). Prove engagement before scaling.
Poor free to premium conversion	Medium	High	Test price points. Consider £9.99 entry tier. Make AI explanations genuinely useful, not gimmicky.

Content quality problems	Medium	Medium	Seed with curated content. Build moderation tools early. Community reporting system.
Deepstash or competitor copies social features	Low	Medium	Move fast. Community loyalty is hard to replicate. Focus on depth over breadth.
AI costs scale faster than revenue	Medium	Medium	Cap free tier AI queries. Optimise prompts. Consider local models for simple explanations.
Platform feels empty at launch	High	High	Pre launch content seeding. Invite only beta. Do not open to public until 1,000+ content pieces exist.
Copyright issues with academic content	Low	High	Use only open access papers. Partner with publishers for licensed content. Clear attribution.

10. Pilot Launch Strategy

Launch happens in three stages. The first is a closed beta with 200 to 500 invited users, primarily university students from two or three UK campuses. The goal is to test engagement patterns, content quality, and whether the social features actually get used. This runs for 8 to 12 weeks.

The second stage is an open beta, still web only, expanding to 2,000 to 5,000 users through targeted social media campaigns on Instagram, TikTok, and Reddit (academic subreddits). Premium subscriptions are introduced at this stage at a discounted £9.99 per month "early adopter" rate.

The third stage is the full public launch with the native mobile app. This is when the £15 per month premium price takes effect and advertising is integrated into the free tier. The target is 10,000 to 15,000 users within 6 months of public launch.

The GCSE and A Level section launches as a separate content area during the open beta, positioned as "study with Knowledgeable" in marketing to younger users and their parents.

The full phased action plan with timelines, milestones, and decision gates is provided in the separate Action Plan document.